

WHY THE WORLD IS FALLING BEHIND T20 LEAGUES

INTERNATIONAL T20 CRICKET, ESPECIALLY WORLD CUPS, MAY BE LAGGING BEHIND THE HIGH STANDARDS SET BY FRANCHISE LEAGUES. HERE'S WHY.

Dhruva Prasad, Pranay Rajiv, Anish Pathiyil

dhruva.prasad@thehindu.co.in, pranay.rajiv@thehindu.co.in, anish.p@thehindu.co.in

The recently concluded edition of the Indian Premier League (IPL) spawned conversations about the direction in which T20 cricket was headed as teams posted scarcely believable scores, and some even chased them down in the same contest. With the 2024 IPL season logging a staggering average tournament strike rate of 150.58 — the highest ever in its history by a distance — the ensuing conversations were inevitably about the evolving nature of the game and the need to adapt to it.

The consensus was that there would be some at the forefront of the revolution, while the reactionaries would be left to fend for themselves.

With a T20 World Cup dawning and national squads being announced during the course of the IPL, there were

polarising opinions of certain inclusions and omissions, with the recency bias of the aggressive brand of cricket on display coming into play. But cricketers are creatures of circumstance as much as of instinct, and the former seems to supersede the latter when the stakes are high.

Quite counter-intuitively, the last two editions of the T20 World Cup have been the slowest scoring in terms of tournament strike rates, and the most attacking batters in franchise cricket seem to curb their instincts when they turn out in national colours on the global stage.

